



12-12-2023 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=cMRUFLuQbIM
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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(None)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting was called to order by the presiding officer. Presenting entities included Muncie Community Schools board leadership, administrative staff, and student representatives.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Dr. O'Neal, Mr. Heeter, Natasha Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvine, Mr. Lee (Note: Presiding officer/President Williams is also explicitly referenced throughout).
 - **Members Absent:** None explicitly noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Identified as President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Observed a moment of silence [00:06:32](#).
 - The Pledge of Allegiance was led by students from Northview Elementary [00:06:45](#).

- Student musical performances included a song by Northview Elementary students (learning sign language for a Veterans Day program) 00:08:25.
- Recognition of Zland Green, who designed the corporation's holiday card 00:12:27.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text provided.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:14:02 **Northview Elementary School Corporation Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by the Northview team, including Master Teacher Leah Brittain and Mentor Teacher Nisha Stout.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Highlighted increased enrollment (from 339 to 368 students), addition of modular classrooms and an upcoming awning, athletic achievements (volleyball final four, elementary city basketball championship, new Pep Squad), active PTO, and student choir performances. Academic goals focus on I-LEARN and I-READ targets, attendance improvement (targeting 95%), implementation of the CKLA (Core Knowledge Language Arts) reading curriculum, mclass assessments, and math labs utilizing Ball State and IV Tech practicum students.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote required.
- 00:38:35 **Superintendent's Administrative Report (Dr. K)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. K (Superintendent)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Addressed the IDOE reading instruction stipends for K-3 teachers; upcoming site visits from Vincin Community Schools regarding the City Connects program; the first annual Fieldhouse Classic basketball tournament; leadership updates at the Muncie Area Career Center (MAC); the upcoming broadcast of the community sing on WIPB TV; a localized gas pump fundraising partnership with Southside Middle School; and collaboration with the Muncie Police Department for student engagement and recess/reading support.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report.
- 00:51:16 **Addition to Consent Agenda: Countywide School Safety Commission (House Bill 1492 / IC 10-21-12)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Legal counsel / Board leadership.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed statutory requirements enacted in the last legislative session mandating a countywide school safety commission by December 31, 2023. Because Muncie Community Schools has the largest ADA in the county, it holds administrative responsibilities for appointments and leadership. The board discussed designating Dr. Cukowski (or her designee) to populate the committee to satisfy the statutory deadline.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (part of the broader consent agenda).
- **00:54:37 Recognition of Retirees & Consent Agenda Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board Leadership / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Recognized retiring staff members: Dinda Const (Westview Elementary, 36 years), Sher Dyer (Southside Middle School, 34.5 years), and Reva Haj (Northview Elementary, 6 years). The board moved to approve the consent agenda containing committee designations, personnel recognitions, and routine updates.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote.
- **00:57:00 Financial Report & Investment/Interest Policy**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad D. (Financial Director / Mr. Duram)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented November financial results, noting receipt of the state basic grant (\$4+ million), distribution of the state TAG grant to qualified teachers, and upcoming support staff stipends (\$500) for December 20th. Cash balance stands at over \$33.7 million (up roughly \$22 million over 5 years). Noted the final payment on the 2014 GO Bond to the Bank of New York occurring in December, steady state loan repayments (\$50,000/month), and the approved 2024 tax rate. Discussed conservative investment policies regarding interest income.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:02:40 School Calendars (Revised 2024<U+2013>2025 & Proposed 2025<U+2013>2026)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented minor tweaks to the 2024<U+2013>2025 calendar and proposed the 2025<U+2013>2026 calendar. Key changes include starting teachers on a Monday and students on a Wednesday, shifting days to allow three full student days after Memorial Day (high school finals week), and reducing 2-hour early release professional development days from monthly down to four days per year to ease family childcare burdens.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **01:09:18 Revised and Retired Policy Updates**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Legal.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented policy updates, including the capital expenditure policy and financial/investment policies cleaned up for statutory alignment.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(Note: General public comments from adult community members were not featured during this portion of the meeting; however, high school students attending from Muncie Central High School participated in interactive dialogue with the board regarding a Court of Appeals on Wheels program visit [00:44:21](#)).

- [00:44:21](#) **Student Representative (Unnamed Muncie Central Student)**: Addressed the board regarding the Court of Appeals on Wheels session held earlier in the day featuring a three-judge panel criminal case argument.
- [01:14:14](#) **Muncie Central Senior Students (Olivia, Clarissa, Jan, Jacob, Samantha, and peers)**: Spoke briefly about their post-graduation plans, including studying computer science, media production, and attending business/university programs.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Holiday broadcasts of the community sing on WIPB TV scheduled for Christmas Day at 5:00 PM [04:13:32](#).
 - Next financial reports and Board of Finance updates anticipated in January [00:58:25](#).
- **Adjournment:** Official motion to adjourn carried by voice vote [01:15:10](#).

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